The one page checklist

"Keep an adequate supply of essential items."

Be Emergency Ready, posted to 2.2 million Irish households, September 2026

It never says how much. This page does.

01 The first ten minutes

1. **Stand still, get one proper light in your hand.** Not a candle. The commonest injury in a dark house is a fall on the stairs.
2. **Area or house?** Look for a neighbour's light or a street light. If they are on, check the consumer unit for one switch out of line.
3. **Unplug what minds a spike:** TV, computer, router, washing machine, anything charging. **Leave on:** one hall light, the fridge, the freezer, the alarm.
4. **Ring ESB Networks on 1800 372 999,** even if the whole parish is out. Have your MPRN and Eircode ready.
5. **Open powercheck.esbnetworks.ie and screenshot it.** A screenshot survives the loss of signal. A browser tab does not.
6. **Write the time on paper** on the kitchen table. You will need it for the freezer, the fridge and the battery.

02 Water, per person, per day

7 litres to drink and cook with. 15 litres for everything else. Only the first 7 has to be bought and stored properly.

People	Drinking, 7 days	Everything else
1	49 L	105 L
2	98 L	210 L
3	147 L	315 L
4	196 L	420 L
5	245 L	525 L
6	294 L	630 L

On a well or a group scheme? Your water stops the second the power does. The pressure vessel holds about 7 usable litres. One flush of an old cistern.

03 Food, per adult, per day

Plan on 2,000 kcal. Seven days is 14,000 kcal per adult, and a shelf that needs no cooking and no cold.

- ☐ Tinned main meals, 7
- ☐ Tinned fish or meat, 4
- ☐ Tinned beans and pulses, 4
- ☐ Crackers or oatcakes, 2 packs
- ☐ Peanut butter, 1 jar
- ☐ Long life milk, 2 litres
- ☐ Porridge oats, 500 g
- ☐ Dried fruit and nuts, 400 g
- ☐ Biscuits or chocolate, 1 pack
- ☐ **A manual tin opener, and a spare**

That is roughly €55 in own brand and it fits in one crate. Check for a ring pull on every tin before you trust one opener.

04 Power, honestly

Essentials: phones, two lights, radio	430 Wh a day
Add the fridge freezer, in cycles	733 Wh a day
Add the oil boiler and its pump	1,733 Wh a day
A 20,000 mAh power bank delivers	3 phone charges
A 100 Ah AGM battery delivers	about 510 Wh
A 100 Ah LiFePO4 delivers	about 910 Wh

Light, in order: head torch first, because it leaves both hands free. Then the battery lantern, the hand torch, the phone, and a long way behind, the candle.

Your oil boiler is an electrical appliance. A full tank heats nothing without about 150 watts for the burner, the controls and the circulating pump.

05 Heat, one room, eight hours a day

Fuel	Per day	7 days
Dry wood, under 20% moisture	11 kg	77 kg
Low smoke ovoids	7 kg	49 kg
Peat briquettes	13 kg	91 kg

A week of one room heat is about half a cubic metre, stored dry and off the floor, and about €40 to €80. Buy it in October.

06 Cash, because the terminal is down too

€300 in the house, in notes people can actually give change for.

10 × €20 + 7 × €10 + 2 × €5 + €20 in coin

07 The list with no exceptions

Carbon monoxide has no colour and no smell. People who die of it are usually asleep.

- × Never a generator in a garage, a shed, a porch or under a window. Outdoors, well away, exhaust pointed off.
- × Never a barbecue indoors, including one that looks like it has gone out. Charcoal gives off CO for hours.
- × Never a camping stove or a patio heater indoors.
- × Never the gas cooker or the oven to heat a room.
- × Never a generator or inverter wired into the house without a changeover switch fitted by a Registered Electrical Contractor.
- × **Fit an alarm marked EN 50291.** €16 to €30. Check the marking on the back of the unit, not on the box.

This page is the summary. The book is the arithmetic.

blackoutready.ie

Blackout Ready: The Irish Home Plan is five parts and thirty-nine chapters, every quantity sized, priced and costed in euro for an Irish house. The pump on a well. The 12V system that is not a generator. Heat when the heating is electric. Growing food here, month by month. The ration scale, in grams, for when a week becomes three. What to do while the ambulance is still forty minutes away. And an eighteen sheet workbook that turns all of it into your numbers.